

Ocean Shield Trust

Mission: Protect coastal ecosystems and strengthen fisher communities through marine conservation and resilient livelihoods.

Focus areas:

- Reef and mangrove restoration
- Sustainable fishing
- Plastic mitigation
- Disaster preparedness

Programs:

- Community reef monitoring
- Mangrove nurseries
- Gear-swap for bycatch reduction
- Ocean plastic collection with buyback

Geographic focus: Tamil Nadu and Kerala coasts; island pilots

Beneficiaries: Small-scale fisher families, women SHGs, and youth

Annual impact highlights:

- 42 ha mangroves restored
- 18 reef transects protected
- 420 tons plastic removed
- 1,300 households trained

Registration & Compliance

Registrations:

- 12A
- 80G
- CSR-1
- FCRA: Registered

Policies:

- Environmental Safeguards
- Community Safeguarding
- Data Transparency

Governance: Science advisory panel with open-source monitoring data

SDG Alignment

Relevant SDGs:

- SDG14 Life Below Water
- SDG13 Climate Action
- SDG1 No Poverty

Monitoring & Evaluation

M&E; Approach:

- Ecological monitoring (transects, survival rates)
- Fish catch quality/effort trends (community logs)
- Plastic diversion audits

Key Risks & Mitigations

Risks:

- Storm damage — Staggered planting and species mixes
- Low community buy-in — Revenue-sharing from plastic buyback

Partnerships

Key partners:

- Fisher cooperatives
- Forest departments
- Marine research labs

Operational KPIs:

KPI	Baseline	Latest	Target
Mangrove Survival @12m	—	78%	85%
Bycatch Reduction	—	22%	30%
Plastic Diverted (t/yr)	—	420	500

Case Study

A gear-swap pilot cut bycatch by 27% and improved net margins via selective nets and buyer incentives.

FAQs

Q: Do you pay for plastic?

A: Yes—through verified buyback partners at fair rates.

Q: Who owns restored areas?

A: Government/community; stewardship agreements apply.

Volunteer & Donate

Volunteer opportunities:

- Beach clean-ups
- Nursery care
- Community data logging

Donate: Adopt-a-reef/mangrove plots; 80G/12A

Financials & Contact

Financial snapshot: FY 2023–24: INR 4.0 Cr; 85% program, 10% admin, 5% fundraising

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Note: Sample profile for testing and evaluation.